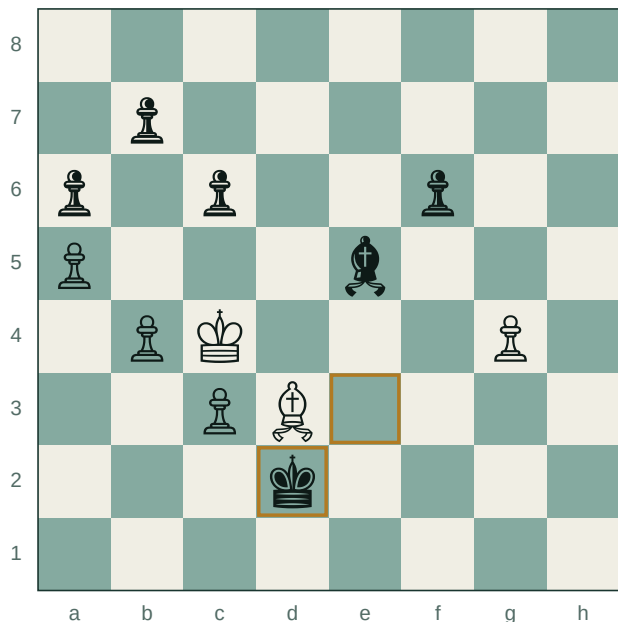


Bishop-ending decisions: White, move 61

Bishop-ending decisions

White to move



Previous move: 60...Kd2. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

61. Bf5 Bc7 62. Bc8 b6 63. axb6 Bxb6 64. Bxa6

61.Bf5 The bishop moves from d3 to f5. Recorded reply: **61...Bc7**.

62.Bc8 The bishop moves from f5 to c8. Recorded reply: **62...b6**.

63.axb6 The pawn captures the pawn on b6. Recorded reply: **63...Bxb6**.

64.Bxa6 The bishop captures the pawn on a6.

At the end, nominal material is White 6 / Black 5 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +1. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +1:** the balance goes from +0 to +1. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Same-colored and opposite-colored bishop endings have different tendencies, but neither label replaces calculation of the actual pawn races.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A bishop ending depends on diagonal access, pawn color, king activity, and promotion squares. Tactics can arise when a bishop must perform two defensive jobs.

HOW TO LOOK

Trace the bishop's line to each target and identify pawns that can break its coverage or force it to move.

The defending king is on d2. Look for a defender that can be displaced or overloaded.